

LUCKNOW | Stone Rage

After keeping mum over Mulayam Singh Yadav's tirade against her, Chief Minister Mayawati has lashed out at the Samajwadi Party (SP) chief. Mulayam has been saying that once voted back to power, he would raze all the statues installed by Mayawati. "I will not tolerate such brazen misuse of public money," Mulayam has threatened many times. While laying the foundation stone for yet another park in the name of Kanshi Ram, Mayawati lashed out at her arch rival, saying, "If anyone dares touch the statues of Dalit icons there will be such a law and order problem that the entire country will be under President's rule." She also warned the Congress not to support the SP in its agenda of dismantling the statues.



MAYAWATI'S STATUES HAVE DRAWN FLAK FROM MULAYAM

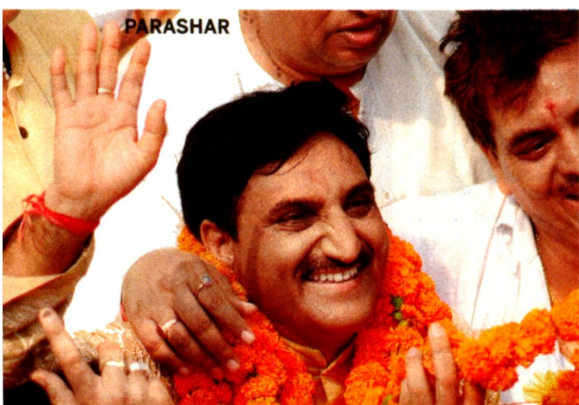
Recently, Mayawati had to evacuate workers at numerous parks following a Supreme Court order to stop construction at all the sites with immediate effect. She is already facing flak from various quarters for building the massive parks and statues in Uttar Pradesh. **by Subhash Mishra**

Hard Talk

The DMK's request to the Lok Sabha secretary that all their queries in the Q&A session be answered in Tamil instead of in English or Hindi has been snubbed. Azhagiri's attempt at nursing Tamil pride just ran into the language barrier.

DEHRADUN | Winning Unity

The BJP's gamble of appointing Ramesh Pokhriyal 'Nishank' as the Uttarakhand chief minister seems to be paying off with a win in the recent Vikas Nagar by-election. BJP candidate Kuldip



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Parashar won by over 60 per cent of the vote, ending speculation over strife within the state unit of the party. The BJP was being seen in a rapid decline in Uttarakhand, losing popularity due to infighting and factionalism. In the last Lok Sabha polls, the BJP had lost all five seats, which had triggered a fresh bout of infighting between supporters of then chief minister Bhuwan Chand Khanduri and his arch rival Bhagat Singh Koshiyari. Nishank had replaced Khanduri as the state's fifth chief minister on June 27. The by-poll win has established Pokhriyal as the unanimous leader of the two rival factions of the BJP, which had been divided vertically ever since the 2007 Assembly elections. **by Subhash Mishra**

DELHI |

Plastic Reality

The seizure of large quantities of fake Rs 1,000 and Rs 500 notes has led the RBI to toy with the idea of replacing paper currency with polymer notes. As a pilot project, the Central bank is planning to introduce one billion pieces of Rs 10 polymer notes, for which the bank has floated a global tender. The bank has asked interested parties for 500 pieces of sample banknotes, before the actual global bids for

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PAPER NOTES MAY BE REPLACED WITH PLASTIC ONES

the project go through. Polymer notes are extremely difficult to counterfeit and have a lifespan of five years compared to paper currency which lasts just one year. They can also be washed, making them more hygienic. Central banks the world over believe that the only sure way to control counterfeiting is through continuous design change and innovation. The RBI had first hinted in 2007 that it may start using plastic notes. **by Nivedita Mukherjee**